

SARANAC LAKE

Park Vision Plan

March 30th, 2018



WILLIAM WALLACE PARK

WILLIAM WALLACE PARK | Overview

NAME: William Wallace Park and Beach, referred to as Lake Colby Beach
LOCATION: On Lake Colby, next to Moir Rd, off of Broadway (Rt. 86).
PARK'S PURPOSE: Swimming and beach activity including volleyball and open space play.

The Lake Colby beach area provides a scenic lakefront setting for a variety of uses. The water quality is good and the beach area is maintained but the overall park facility is not well utilized due to poor lawn drainage. Swimming is allowed while life guards are present, otherwise the entire park is locked and not open for use. The existing structure on the site is in very poor condition and should be removed. A new bathroom structure should be constructed in a different location on the property if the regulatory permitting allows.

Community leaders recognize that the Village of Saranac Lake must successfully package a blend of the Village's best recreational resources to retain and attract new businesses and residents. The Lake Colby beach represents an important community asset and must be improved. Lake Colby has an established history of public use for over 35 years and is a cherished community resource.

EXISTING AMENITIES:

The building on site provides restrooms and changing areas. A gravel parking area and picnic tables are also located in the park. A large lawn and other amenities provide opportunity for various outdoor recreational activities for families with young children, water sports enthusiasts, and nature lovers. The beach is a convenient driving distance from the Village center.

POTENTIAL ADDITIONAL AMENITIES:

- Access should be provided to the park while lifeguards are not present.
- A new beach building and bathrooms should be constructed. Provide ADA access to existing restrooms if a new structure is not built.
- Additional playground equipment with slides and climbing features are desired. Consider a waterplay area. The Lake Everest Park in Wilmington provides a good example of playground amenities.
- Provide picnic tables, a pavilion, grills, and a fire area.
- Provide a universally accessible fishing pier and kayak/canoe hand-launch with access from Moir Drive. Also consider a boardwalk connection from the dock to the main park.
- Shade should be provided at the edge of the beach area without impacting the primary recreational opportunities at this park.
- Maintain open views throughout the park that allow children to play in the water, on the beach, and in the lawn area.
- Additional landscape plantings could enhance the park to partially screen the road and reduce wind effects, especially at the north end of the parking area.
- The lawn area should be expanded to provide for greater recreational use of the site.
- Consider commercial rental opportunities for kayaks, canoes and SUPs.
- Develop a plan and facilities for four-season use of the park that may include ice skating, ice-fishing, or motorized winter sports. Coordinate with the Lake Colby Association.
- Expand youth and family programs/facilities.
- Enhance sidewalk and trail connections to the park to/from the Village, adjacent parklands and recreational centers.

LEGAL TOPICS:

- Currently the park is not open when a lifeguard is not present. The Village is investigating ways to provide access to the park.

POTENTIAL USE CONFLICTS:

- See "Legal Topics" above.

WILLIAM WALLACE PARK | Priority Projects

CURRENT MAINTENANCE TOPICS:

- Improve the quality of the beach area with better sand.
- Improve drainage in the lawn area.
- The existing building is in very poor condition.

PRIORITY PROJECTS:

- Investigate Department of Health regulations regarding park use when a life guard is not present. Identify a strategy to expand park hours to provide access to the park. Consider a potential fence around the beach area and signage.
- Replace/Rehabilitate the existing bathhouse based on feasible construction costs and governing regulations. In the near-term, provide a sheltered and screened enclosure for portable toilets and changing area.
- Consider adding a picnic pavilion and/or design as an extension of a new bathhouse. If a separate pavilion is constructed it could serve as a shelter and warming hut for multi-seasonal activities and winter sports.
- Improve the sand beach area and provide children's play equipment.
- Address the drainage issues in the southwestern lawn area.
- Improve the park entrance, parking area, signage, and emergency access drive.
- Provide a park sign and user regulation signage.
- Explore opportunities to expand winter recreational activities.
- Move the accessible garden beds to the community garden site on Old Lake Colby Road.

WILLIAM WALLACE PARK | Existing Conditions



WILLIAM WALLACE PARK | Concept Plan



WILLIAM WALLACE PARK | Concept Rendering

